

# Fix the portfolio's efficiency. Use the festival as the engine.

My first month as Music Creator Manager · Belle He · August 2026 · “From your room to the main stage.”

1 · COACH BY ARCHETYPE

The portfolio's problem is **efficiency, not effort**: the most active creators are declining. One verdict and one plan per creator.

→ page 3

2 · FESTIVAL AS ENGINE, NOT EVENT

The **Road to Pulse Creator Program** recruits new music creators, re-energizes existing ones, and engineers the heat instead of hoping for it.

→ pages 4-6

3 · BASELINE-DISCIPLINED DELIVERY

Targets are set against a defined baseline, **leading indicators gate every dollar**, and a W4 go/no-go keeps the plan honest.

→ pages 2, 7-8

**\$80K**

activation budget

**8 weeks**

to festival, five phases

**5 + open**

managed creators + open recruitment

**ROI ≈ 5-6x**

target, convention to confirm

## OBJECTIVES & BASELINE

# Define the pond before fishing: vertical scope, baseline discipline, targets with a basis

Scope and metric conventions come first; every number later in this deck traces back to this page.

### 1 · VERTICAL DEFINITION & SIZING

- **Pan-music creators:** singing, instruments, DJ sets, production. Broad at the vertical level, precise per creator
- The five managed creators are the showcase anchors; recruitment extends to short-video musicians
- Persona: **16-34, urban, EDM / DJ-culture adjacent**; DJ sets, remixing, singer-songwriters, instrumentalists — validate wk 1
- Definition sets the pond size: recruitable pool estimated from tagged music content (tooling + manual tagging)

### 2 · BASELINE DISCIPLINE

- Baseline = **7-day averages** at period start and end, outlier days (platform mega-campaigns) removed
- Success is read as **campaign period vs baseline**, never raw totals
- Key campaign actions are scheduled to **cover the measurement window**, not drift past it

### 3 · TARGETS, WITH A BASIS

- **Vertical:** daily streaming actives and daily revenue vs baseline; actives are carried by tail and new creators, revenue by the top
- **Campaign top creators:** revenue +100%+ during campaign, paying-user share +30-40%, per-payer spend +20-45%, follower growth
- **ROI  $\approx$  5-6x:** campaign-period revenue  $\div$  \$80K (convention to confirm)

Targets come from comparable-campaign history and get locked against internal baseline data in week 1. **A target without a baseline convention is an opinion.**

### ADDITIONAL INFORMATION I WOULD REQUEST

Internal tier standards and where the five sit · content profiles · ROI & measurement conventions (campaign vs baseline?) · traffic sources, payer concentration, 90-day trends · MoM 0.09/0.22 read as +9%/+22%

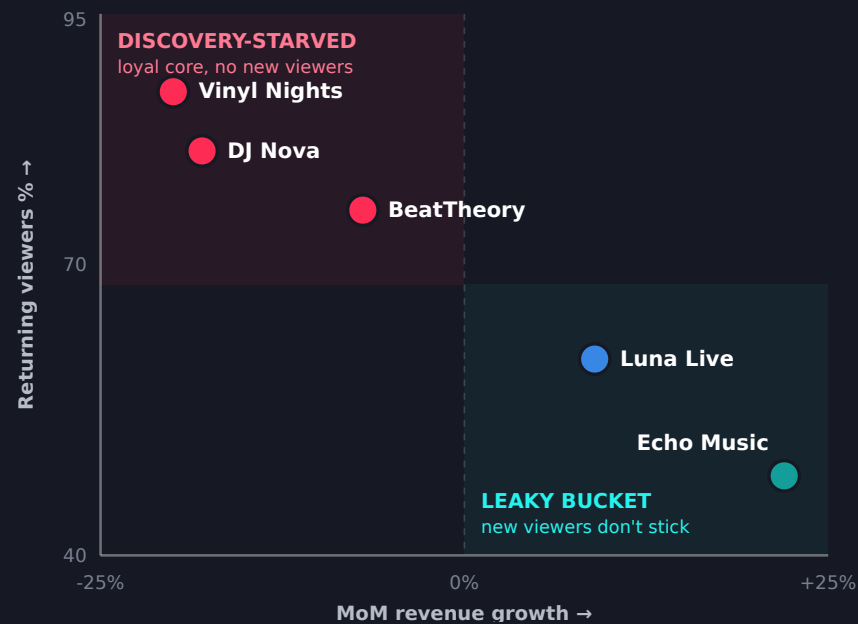
# The most active creators are declining: an efficiency problem, not an effort problem

Last 30 days. Revenue per LIVE hour spans 5× across the portfolio.

| CREATOR        | LIVE HRS | AVG CCV | REVENUE  | REV / HR | MOM  | RETURNING |
|----------------|----------|---------|----------|----------|------|-----------|
| ● Echo Music   | 38       | 1,250   | \$12,100 | \$318    | +22% | 48%       |
| ● Luna Live    | 58       | 910     | \$17,600 | \$303    | +9%  | 60%       |
| ● DJ Nova      | 115      | 430     | \$14,200 | \$123    | -18% | 81%       |
| ● BeatTheory   | 90       | 310     | \$10,400 | \$116    | -7%  | 75%       |
| ● Vinyl Nights | 126      | 185     | \$7,800  | \$62     | -20% | 87%       |

Hours and growth are **inversely related**: the two creators streaming the most are declining fastest. The portfolio needs **better hours, not more hours**. Portfolio-level: **\$62.1K** total, weighted MoM **-3.4%**; Luna + Echo generate **48% of revenue on 23% of the hours**.

RETURNING VIEWERS VS. REVENUE GROWTH (MOM)



## ONE VERDICT PER CREATOR · BACK THE WINNERS, FIX THE LEAKS

- Echo · BACK P1** — momentum is perishable: fixed schedule, 1v1 dedicated management, welcome rituals + fresh hooks, fan-community VIP events to consolidate payers
- Nova · FIX** — refreshed show formats + new segments, off-peak tests, festival stage slot as a new-audience injection
- BeatTheory · HOLD** — prevention: Luna’s playbook, monthly format experiment, echo-chamber alerts

- Luna · BACK** — codify her playbook portfolio-wide; gentle hours increase; balance can mean a ceiling, content review first
- Vinyl · FIX** — fewer, better hours (126 → ~80), new formats, co-streams with risers, creator×fan second-creation missions
- Overall** — three patterns: leaky-bucket risers, discovery-starved loyalists, balanced. Keep a **10% backup roster**; outreach never converts 100%

# One festival, three funnels: recruit the new, energize the existing, showcase the top

The plan: “**From Your Room to the Main Stage**” · the **Road to Pulse Creator Program**, in five phases. Excitement isn't a separate workstream; it's the output of the other three, clipped and amplified.

1 · Sign-up & warm-up

2 · Launch

3 · Online rounds

4 · Festival weekend

5 · Post-festival push

## RECRUIT

The **Rising division** of Road to Pulse: a dedicated on-ramp for musicians who have never gone LIVE. Short-video missions count as entry, so the funnel starts one level below the official campaigns' eligibility gates.

Feeds: daily streaming actives, new-creator supply

## ENERGIZE

Existing creators compete in the **Headliner division**; a 4-week bootcamp covers streaming craft and the monetization ladder; portfolio creators mentor and perform, which doubles as their discovery fix.

Feeds: engagement, revenue, portfolio recovery

## SHOWCASE

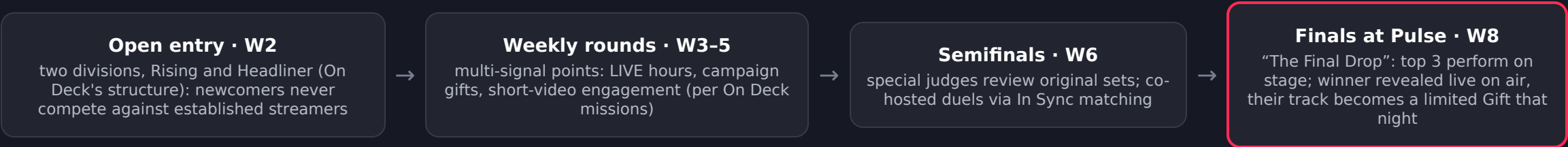
The **TikTok LIVE stage at Pulse**: competition finals and top-talent performances, all streamed to the platform. The stream is the product for the 99% who are not on site.

Feeds: platform heat, brand, showcase goal

Budget detail sits in the appendix (page 8), deliberately concentrated on the stage and the competition: they compound each other, and marketing amplifies a story the competition creates for free.

# "Road to Pulse", modeled on On Deck: Breakaway, with the entry gate the official campaigns don't have

Proven architecture, deliberately copied. My changes target what On Deck leaves open: recruiting pre-LIVE musicians, and day-31 aftercare.



THE REWARD LADDER (ON DECK'S DESIGN: CAREER CAPITAL OVER CASH)

| WHO           | REWARD                                                                                                                         | COST                  |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| All entrants  | Pulse avatar frame + campaign badge                                                                                            | ≈ \$0, platform asset |
| Round winners | Diamonds + festival merch                                                                                                      | low                   |
| Semifinalists | VIP Pulse tickets, travel covered                                                                                              | the bulk of \$18K     |
| Top 3         | Stage slot + distribution support (as in Music On Stage) + own track released as a limited-run LIVE Gift (as in Songs of LIVE) | ≈ \$0, priceless      |

Even On Deck's cash-equivalent prizes are modest: the top of the ladder isn't bought, it's platform access. That's why \$18K is enough.

INSIDE EVERY ENTRANT'S ROOM (ON DECK'S PRODUCTION MECHANICS)

- Campaign-exclusive **Pulse Gift** with in-room counter
- **Milestone progress bar**: gift-point thresholds unlock the next reward tier
- **Live rank badge** shown in the room; leaderboard resets weekly
- **Shout-out segment**: entrants thank top supporters on air, a built-in retention ritual

I watched these mechanics run live in On Deck rooms; they double as coaching material for the portfolio.

**Runs alongside: education and the pipeline.** A 4-week bootcamp covers streaming craft and the 1K → Gifts → Subscriptions → Rewards ladder, with portfolio creators as mentors. After the festival, every entrant enters a 30-day incubation track (first LIVE within 2 weeks, 3 streams/week by day 30). The festival is a pipeline, not a finish line. And On Deck itself runs different missions per tier; the platform already coaches by archetype, and I apply the same logic inside the portfolio.

# Heat is engineered: seed it, spike it, then harvest it on site

On TikTok, hot lists run on derivative clips and planted moments. Nothing ignites from a cold start.

## MAKING IT TREND

- **Anthem co-creation:** a star artist records the festival anthem in warm-up; creators cover it, fans duet it. Every trending word and challenge hangs off the program's big idea
- **Planted show moments:** engineered contrast pairings (A×B co-streams) turned into events, pushed with trending-topic words in 2-day concentrated bursts
- **Top creators post through the campaign:** participation ≥80% is a tracked target; amplifier accounts scale the clips

## CREATOR × FAN SECOND CREATION

- **Fan clip missions:** second-creation submissions ranked by like tiers, with reward ladders
- **Targeted, not broadcast:** offered 1v1 to high-stickiness, mass-fan creators; payer structure decides who runs fan campaigns
- **Open clip rights + attendee UGC:** booth QR prompts festival-goers to post; best fan clips hit the stage screens

## ON-SITE & PARTNERS

- **Sponsorship** covers non-content site costs; stage & show programming curated from competition winners; creator-level QR attribution on stage and booth
- **Program team** is measured on qualified creators + platform heat; we deliver pre-event posting in return
- **BD team** assists recruitment; **product team** ships custom event effects; **labels** clear licensing from W1; VIP-ticket inventory and booth placement locked in the SLA

PROJECT PLAN

# Kick off like an owner: results-based milestones, one weekly heartbeat



- ◆ **W1** kickoff: plan + budget + ROI aligned, one owner per workstream; creator 1:1s; licensing starts
- ◆ **W3** sign-up complete at target, campaign tested & live; offline prep starts ◆ **W4** entries go/no-go checkpoint ◆ **W5** qualifiers complete ◆ **W7** finals & logistics locked
- ◆ **W8** festival delivered ◆ **W+4** retention report

BIGGEST RISKS → MITIGATIONS

|                                            |                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Music licensing gaps                       | Confirm rights + replacement tracks from W1; no uncleared set reaches the stage                               |
| Recruitment shortfall (entries or dropout) | Agency pre-commitments; 20-30% outreach over-provision + 10% backup roster; W4 checkpoint triggers paid boost |
| On-site tech failure                       | Redundant streaming setup + full rehearsal in W7                                                              |
| Gift-vote gaming                           | Judge-score gate + anomaly monitoring on voting patterns                                                      |
| Partner deliverables slip                  | SLA with weekly sync; stage specs frozen at W6                                                                |
| Budget overrun                             | 8% contingency + weekly burn review                                                                           |
| On-site content / brand safety             | Dedicated moderation coverage for all festival streams; escalation path agreed with Trust & Safety in advance |

STAKEHOLDERS

**Internal:** Product (custom event effects & tools), Data Science, Marketing, Legal & Music Licensing, Event Ops

**External:** Pulse festival org & program team (their metric: qualified creators + platform heat), BD / agency partners for recruitment, labels & artists

KEEPING IT ON TRACK

W1 kickoff alignment (plan + budget + ROI) · preset standards → layered execution → real-time calibration: daily/weekly data reviews, underperforming metrics trigger immediate adjustment · one owner per workstream · live dashboard on entries, coaching metrics, budget burn

SUCCESS METRICS

# Measure supply first: revenue follows

Targets are set from comparable-campaign history; week 1 locks them against a 7-day, outlier-trimmed baseline.

| LAYER                      | METRIC                                                                                                                         | ILLUSTRATIVE TARGET                                                                     |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Leading · supply           | Competition entries · first-time LIVE creators · portfolio quality-weighted hours · bootcamp completion                        | 500+ entries; 150+ first LIVEs; completion ≥ 60%                                        |
| Process · engagement       | Music-vertical watch time during campaign · portfolio new-viewer share · average concurrent viewers                            | New-viewer share ↑ for Nova & Vinyl; ACV ↑ portfolio-wide                               |
| Lagging · revenue & health | Portfolio revenue MoM · revenue per LIVE hour · paying-user share · per-payer spend · campaign ROI · D30 retention of recruits | MoM positive by W8; payer share +30–40%; per-payer spend +20–45%; ROI ≈ 5–6×; D30 ≥ 40% |
| Coaching · per creator     | Streaming actives & hours · watch UV · follower growth · paying-user share · per-payer spend · watch → pay conversion          | Per-creator targets set in W1 1:1s against each baseline                                |
| Guardrails · execution     | On-site sessions delivered as scheduled · rights & safety incidents · budget adherence                                         | ≥ 90% delivered; zero material incidents; within \$80K                                  |

**Supply and retention are the cause; revenue is the effect.** I act on leading metrics and am judged by lagging ones.

APPENDIX · THE \$80K ACTIVATION BUDGET

|                                 |       |                                      |       |                       |       |
|---------------------------------|-------|--------------------------------------|-------|-----------------------|-------|
| LIVE stage & on-site production | \$28K | Competition prizes & finalist travel | \$18K | Marketing & community | \$16K |
| Creator bootcamp & education    | \$8K  | On-site ops & logistics              | \$4K  | Contingency (~8%)     | \$6K  |

Creator-directed spend splits ≈50% to top + high-potential creators (traffic boosts, content support), the rest to new-creator recruitment. Pacing ≈40% warm-up / 40% campaign & festival / 20% post-festival tail, contingency dynamic. Platform traffic and product support are in-kind.

**Recommendation:** approve this plan, subject to week 1 validation of baseline data, the rights inventory, and partner deliverables.